

The Dugout

Phase 2

Prototype Presentation

SERVICE DESIGN INDS-3011

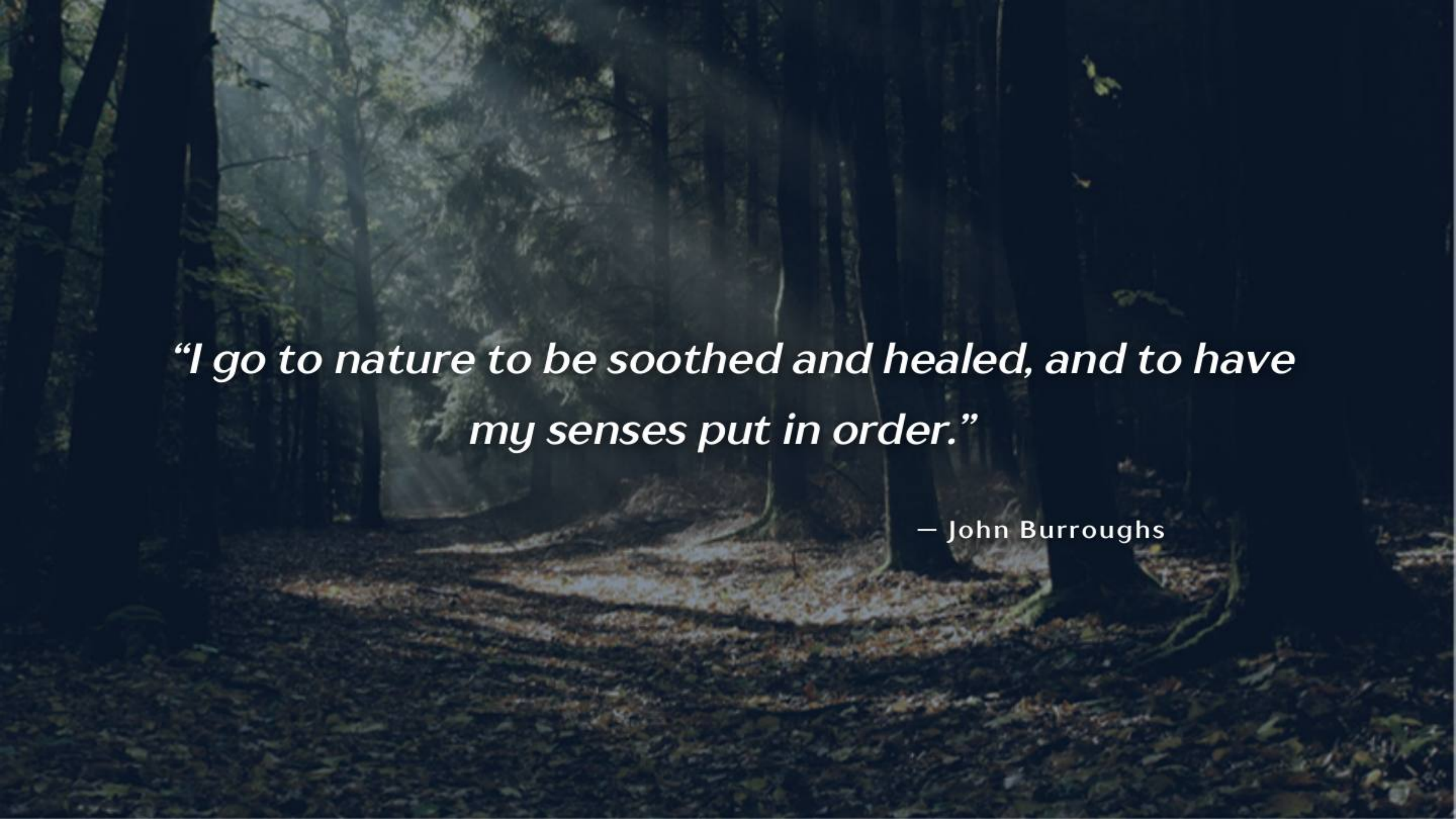
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*“I go to nature to be soothed and healed, and to have
my senses put in order.”*

— John Burroughs

Backstory



Where we started

We started our project with a **site visit**, and secondary **research** of the waterfront in Toronto. Following our site visit, we conducted **interviews** with young adults who live in the city.

Interview findings

After interviewing 7 young adults, we found patterns in their **needs** and **desires** when talking about the objectives of Toronto to be a more welcoming and enjoyable place to live.

Challenges Found

By combining interview insights with our research, we found that Toronto lacks key elements of a community which fosters belonging

From this, we developed three core design pillars:

Safety

Socialization

Affordability

These pillars guided our design process and decision-making throughout the project.





Guiding pillar one:

Safety

How might we design Quayside to remain safe in a high-density setting while supporting seamless daily activities?

“I wouldn’t raise a family here, I don’t want my wife to be downtown alone, too many unpredictable people I can’t trust.”

“There is a lot of danger here, that is one reason a lot of people are afraid to go outside”

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Guiding pillar two:

Affordability

How might we ensure businesses thrive while simultaneously keeping their goods affordable?

"The expenses of living downtown feel like a constant weight on my shoulders"

"I wish I didn't have to choose between staying home alone or spending money to hang out."



Guiding pillar three:

Socialization

How might we create an engaging environment that fosters a healthy community in Quayside?

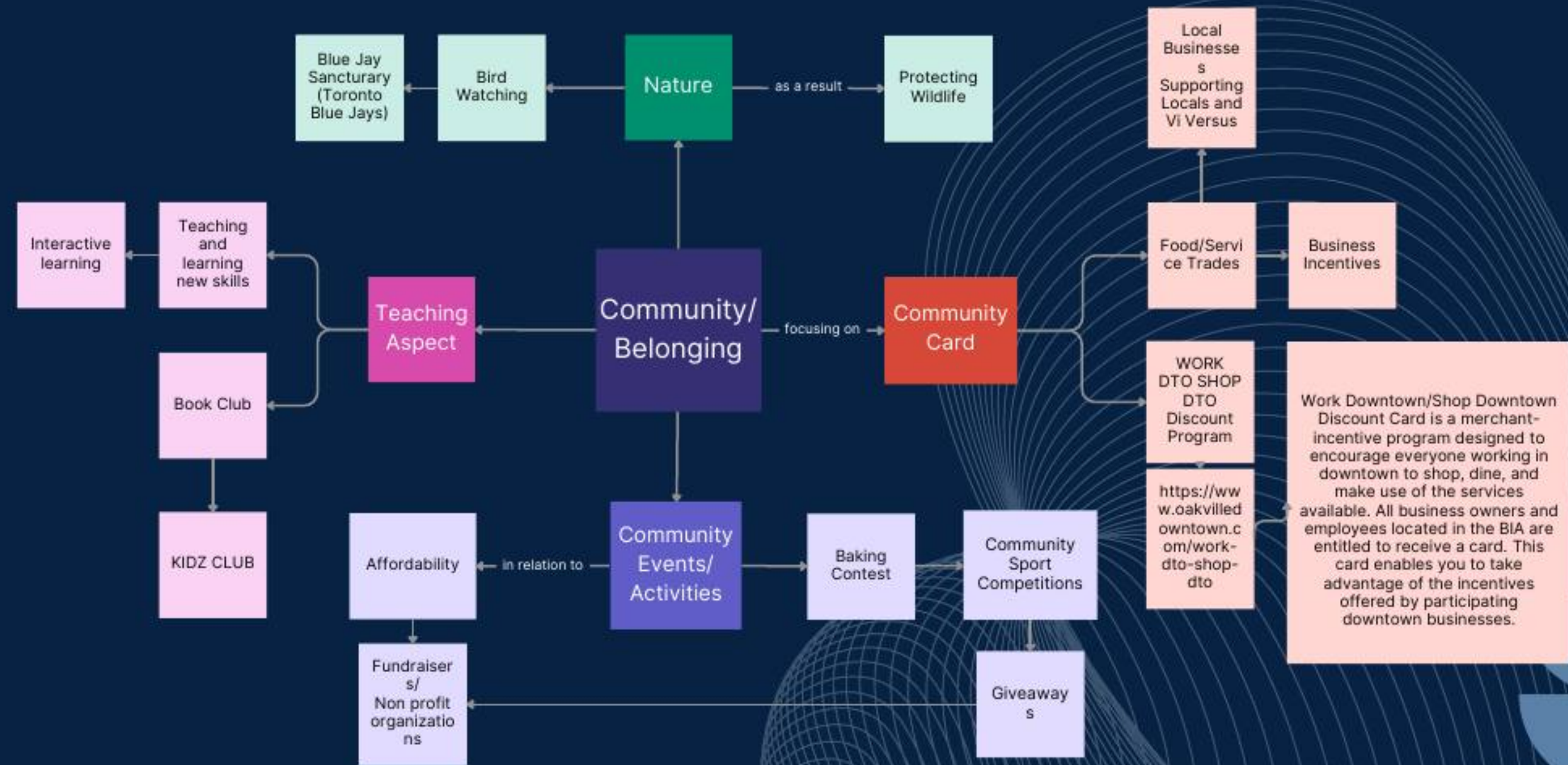
“I wish there was a place to express myself and find individuals with similar interests”

“We need welcoming spots to socialize without pressure.”

Ideation

Once we had our design pillars, we moved on to our long journey of ideation.

We focused on incorporating our stakeholders and ensuring our design was aligned with their needs.

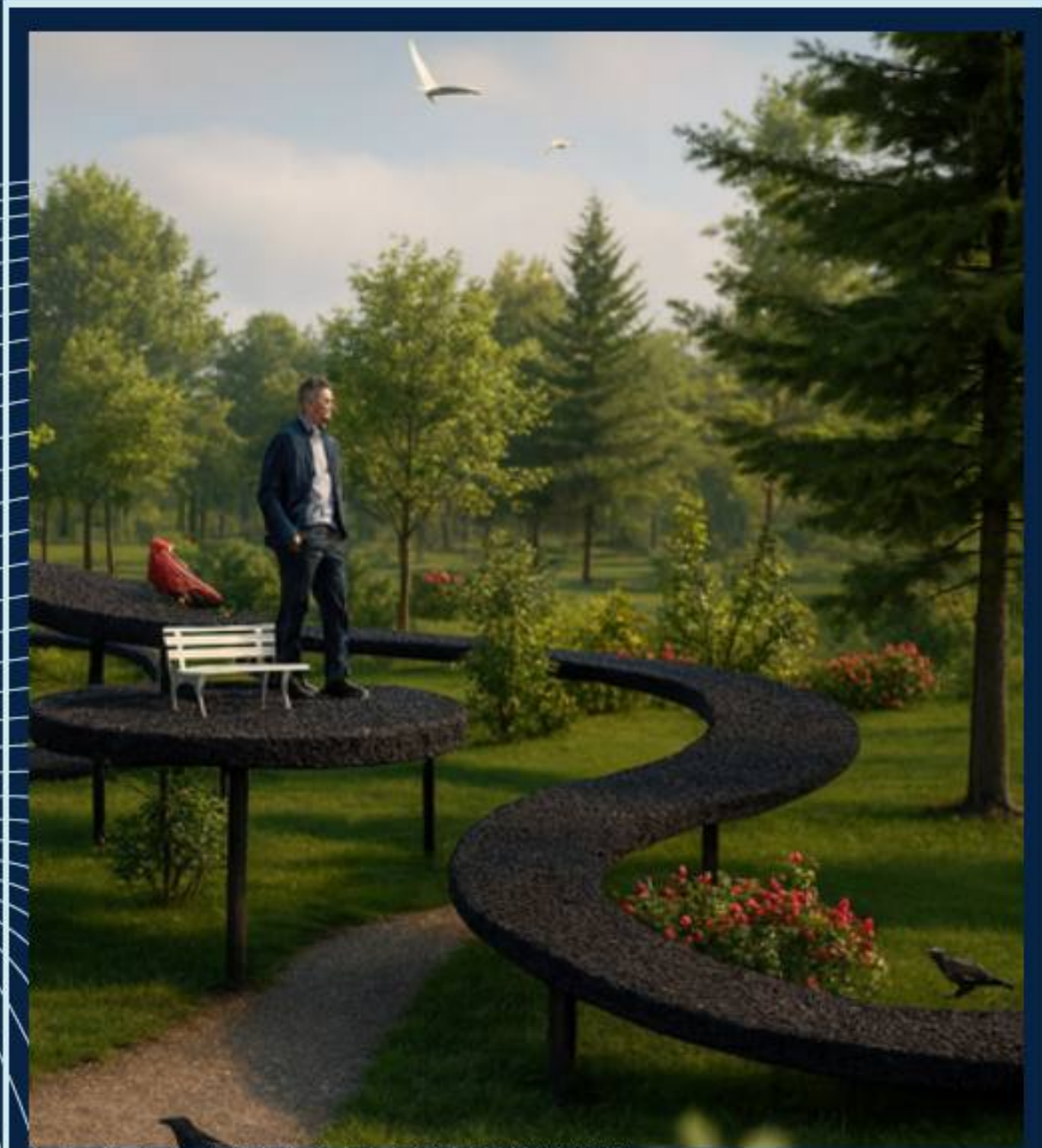


Ideation

One of our first directions was community building and collaborative events.

Our ideation lead us to many ideas, and eventually we ranked them among each other and sorted them into subcategories.





The Dugout

The Dugout is a proposed conservation garden located in the South-East section of the community.

Provides a **purpose-driven gathering** that takes the pressure off simple "hanging out".

Allows for the residence to be **immersed in nature** such as Blue Jays, Cardinals, and Chickadees.

Acts as a launch pad for **community growth**, connection and attraction for prospective residence.

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Living Floorplan

Each plant species in the Blue Jays Garden was carefully chosen to provide year-round food, reliable shelter, and species attraction, ensuring a balanced ecosystem that supports Blue Jays, pollinators, and other native wildlife while enhancing residents' connection to nature.



Understanding Needs Year-Round

Winter

Dormancy & Survival:

The habitat's structural elements (evergreens, benches, and seed heads) maintain visual interest. The focus is on providing high-energy supplemental food (suet, nuts) for wintering birds.

Fall

Seed Bank & Resilience:

Plants enter senescence. The focus shifts to seed collection (for winter feeders/next year's planting) and managing leaf litter for insulation and soil health.



Spring

Renewal & Planting:

The soil thaws, and the native plants begin to sprout. This is the critical window for initial planting and attracting the first wave of pollinators and migrating birds.

Summer

Lush Habitat & Food Production:

The garden reaches its peak, providing dense cover, shade, and primary food sources (berries, seeds) for the Blue Jays and other wildlife.

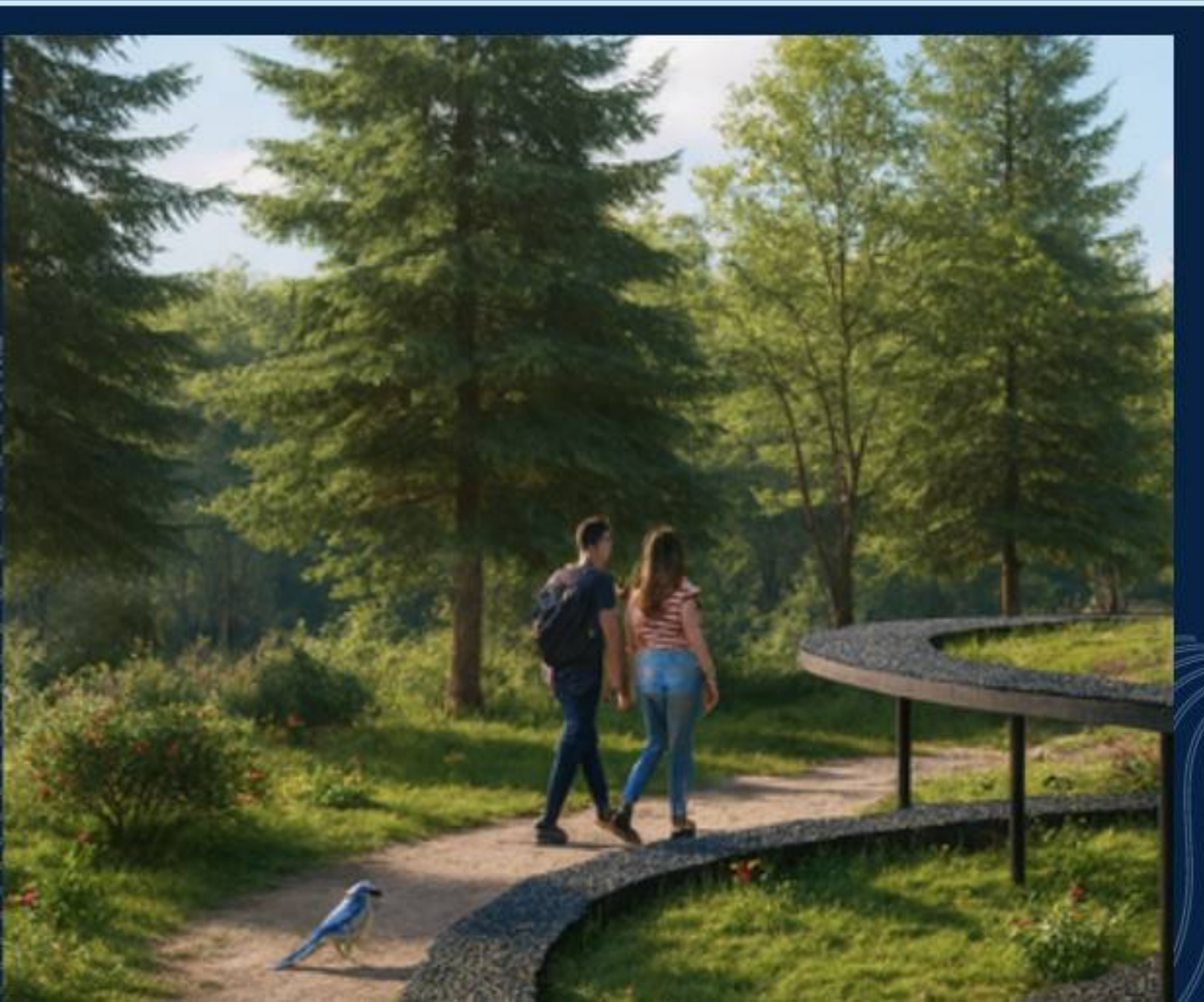
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The Dugout's Services



1

Scavenger Hunts

An interactive outdoor activity suitable for any age group.

2

Events

Weekly and seasonal events to keep a fresh sense in the community.

3

Education

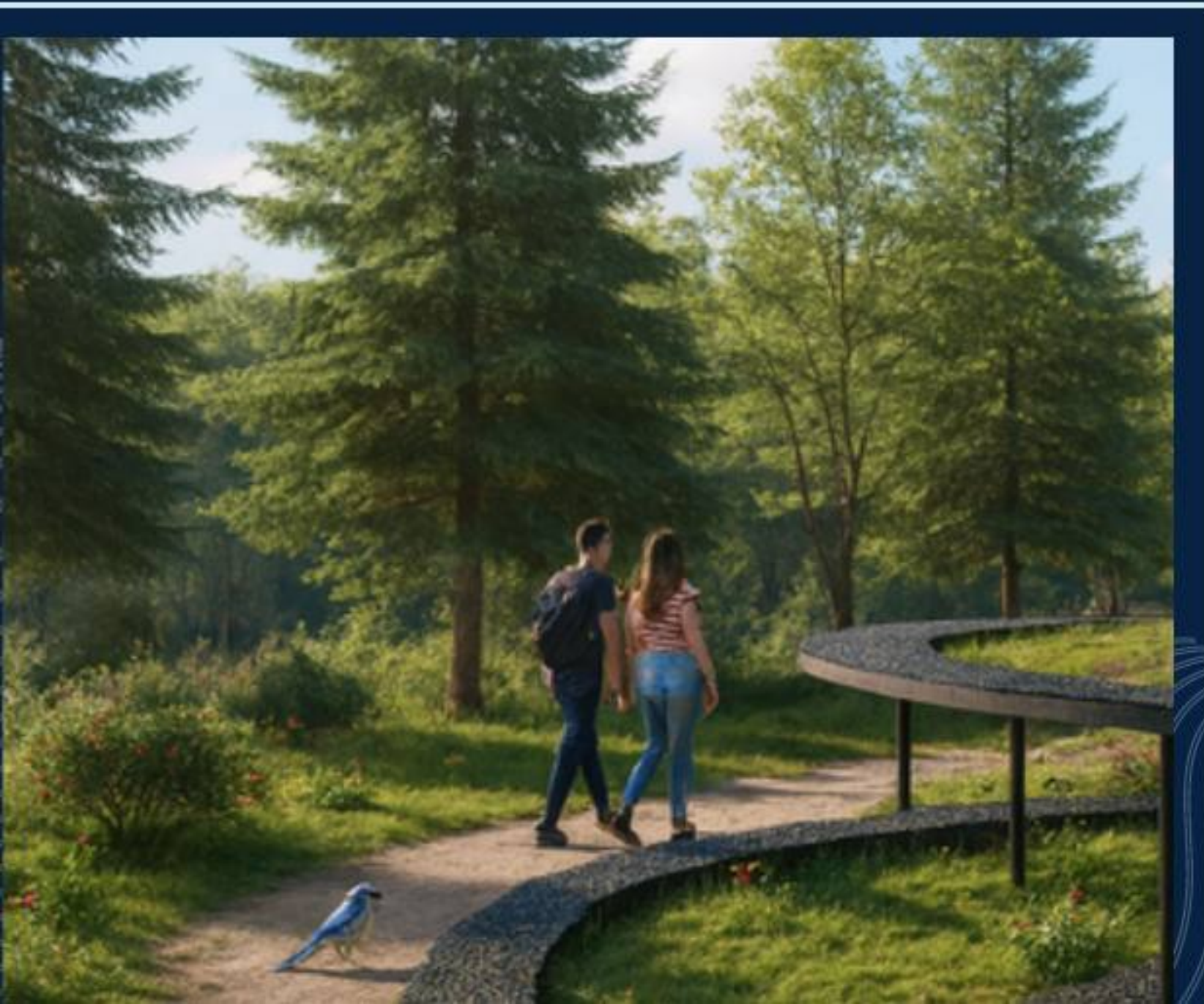
School strips from both the quayside education facility as well as George Brown students in bio-conservation related programs.

4

Gift Shop

Attached to the park, offering blue jay merchandise and bird seed to feed the park birds.

The Dugout's Services –Connection



Develops investment from users and maintains value from the initial discovery to after the user has left the garden

- Services target 5 “E’s” of interaction
- Cater to the level of investment from the visitor

	Blue Jay	
	Butterfly	
	Hummingbird	
	Nest and Egg	
	Spruce Tree	
	Chickadee	
	Dogwood	
	Cardinal	
	Gift Shop	

Service one:

Scavenger hunt

The scavenger hunt will contain 9 individual hole punches each in unique shapes. The shapes will be related to the point of interest.

These hole punches will be attached to information plaques near the natural location of the point of interest.

Eg. The blue jay hole punch will be on a plaque near a visible blue jay nest in a tree.

Eg2. The spruce tree hole punch will be on the edge of a path very close to a spruce tree.

Additionally, the card is made of seed paper, meaning it is able to be planted after its use. It also prevents harmful littering.



Service Two: Events

Events will Occur at the Dugout on a rotational basis, featuring bird experts, participatory rehabilitation events, photography challenges, and celebrity appearances.

- Encourages connection among people with shared interests
- Creates engaging and social experiences
- Keeping the Park Vibrant
- Includes seasonal activities like:
 - Pumpkin carving (fall)
 - Christmas tree lighting (winter)

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Service Three: Education

The Dugout partners with nearby education sites to host school programming in the garden.

Supports early education curriculums at the Quayside education site focused on biodiversity and ecosystems through hands-on learning.

Collaboration with George Brown College allows students to conduct research projects linked to the park.



Service Four:

The Gift Shop

The Dugout will feature an on-site gift shop selling many blue jay related merchandise items like; keychains, birdhouses, magnets, and many more.

This gift shop will also have a, "Adopt a Blue Jay" program, allowing visitors to purchase a stuffed animal representing a real blue jay living in The Dugout without having any grand responsibilities.

Their purchase will go towards supporting the dugout conservation and sustainability initiatives.

Allows for potential partnerships with the MLB Team the Toronto Blue Jays, Cornell LAB, and World Wildlife Foundation.

Monthly Programs

The Dugout will feature monthly calendar programs. Each week has multiple programs anyone can join.

Scavenger Hunts



Photo Contest



Education



Special Events



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JULY 2026

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Design Impact

The Dugout is an effective service that provides a free, accessible space where residents and visitors can engage with nature, learn about local biodiversity, and participate in conservation activities.

Promotes **affordability** and **accessibility** with year-round events, services, activities, and heated pathways in the winter.

Encourages **social interaction** that fosters genuine community connections.

Exciting and unique path shape to provide an **experience** found nowhere else.

Strengthens **neighborhood safety**. Research shows social connectedness reduces violence.

Includes **proper lighting** and security to enhance comfort and safety for all visitors.



Prototype:

Lauren & Fey's Story

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Lauren and Fey both moved downtown for university, from two different small towns in the GTA



They live in the same building complex and enjoy similar activities



But they have never noticed each other.

Prototype:

Lauren & Fey's Story

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One day, Lauren notices a new initiative in her community, a nature scavenger hunt!



Fey is now determined in finding the perfect photo to submit into the community nature photography contest.



Fey notices a beautiful Blue Jay in a tree. And just before she could snap the perfect photo...

Prototype:

Lauren & Fey's Story

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Lauren's scavenger hunt leads her to also find this beautiful Blue Jay, and finally meeting Fey.



Lauren and Fey start walking together in order to finish Lauren's scavenger hunt and find more nature elements Fey can photograph for the contest.



Fey and Lauren now go on weekly walks together, they both enjoy participating in community initiatives at the Blue Jay Garden.

Touchpoints of a Visitor at The Dugout

Touchpoint 2: Entry & Task

Upon entering The Dugout, the visitor could choose to participate in the activities, or they could simply walk the park and admire.

Touchpoint 4: Community

While visitors participate or wander, they may meet others doing the same, allowing for some light small talk which could spiral to a true connection.

Touchpoint 1: Discovery

User sees physical signage or receives a local newsletter introducing The Dugout, it's location, purpose, and further details.

Touchpoint 3: Interaction

The scavenger hunt provides a fun, but also informative experience for the visitor. Or, the photo contest affords a chance to improve on a skill while simultaneously competing in a low-stakes challenge

Feasibility of The Dugout



Safety

- Lighting
- Security
- Signage

Income/Expenses

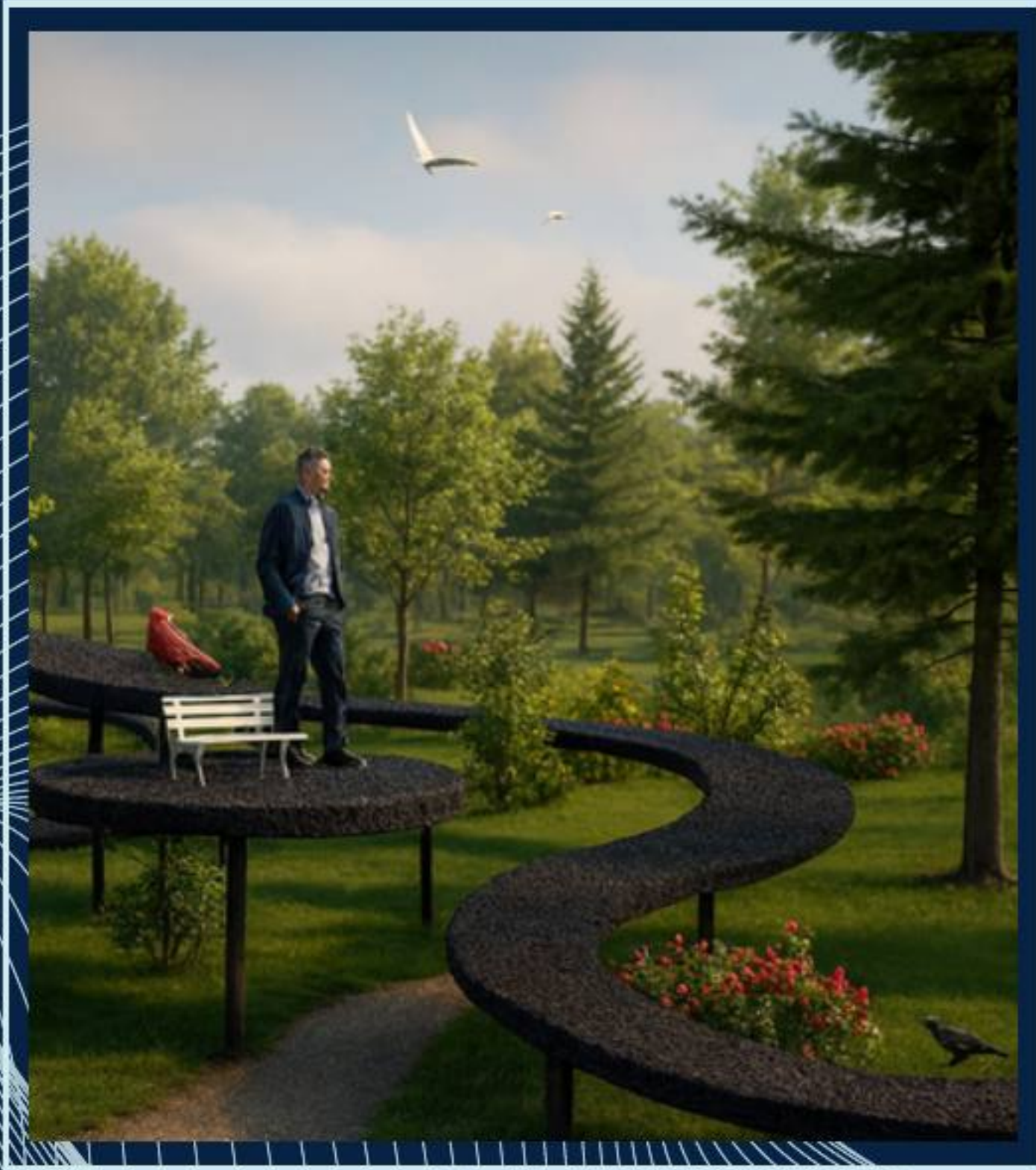
- Allotted budget for Parks and Gardens
- City/Government grants

Staffing

- High job demand in Toronto
- Staff for gift shop, maintenance, reception

Accessibility

- Accommodations for user needs
- Helpful staff, wheelchair accessibility, braille signage, white cane cues
- Hypoallergenic flora incorporation
- 7 degree incline heated ramp to afford all users



Conclusion

The Dugout envisions a free and accessible space where nature, community, and learning come together.

With year-round activities and events that encourage social connections, enhance well-being, and promote conservation, it creates a vibrant and resilient hub for both people and local biodiversity.



Thank You

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